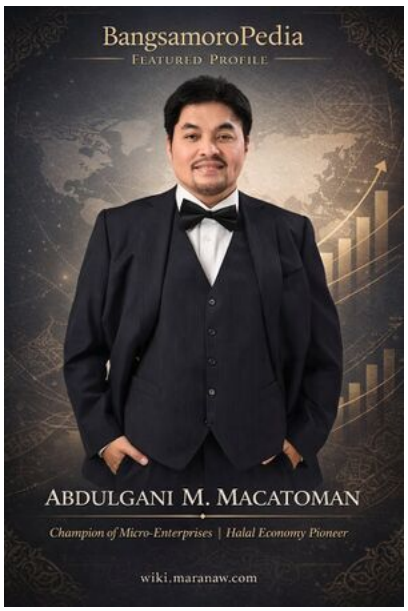
Abdulgani M. Macatoman

Abdulgani M. Macatoman is a prominent Filipino public servant, business leader, and economic development advocate. As a Mindanao-rooted professional, he has championed the growth of micro, small, and medium enterprises across the Philippines, advocated for the protection of overseas Filipino workers, and emerged as a leading voice in the global halal economy. His career spans high-level government service, corporate leadership, and civic engagement, positioning him as a key figure in regional economic cooperation and private sector development in the Bangsamoro region and beyond.



Abdulgani M. Macatoman

Born	Mindanao, Philippines
Nationality	Filipino
Education	University of the East, Philippine Law School
Occupation	Public servant, business leader, entrepreneur
Known for	Micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) advocacy; Halal economy development; overseas Filipino worker protection
Awards	Management Man of the Year (2017), Asian Humanitarian Businessman of the Year, Ten Outstanding Young Filipinos (2012)

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Early Life and Education

Macatoman was born and raised in Mindanao, a heritage that has shaped his lifelong commitment to the region's economic and social development. His educational journey established a rigorous foundation in commerce, law, and business management.

He earned a Bachelor of Science in Commerce with a major in accounting from the University of the East (UE) in 1991. Continuing at UE, he completed his Bachelor of Laws in 1995, followed by a Master of Business Administration in 1999. Beyond formal education, he also became a Certified Public-Private Partnership Consultant and completed the Phronetic Leadership Class through the Development Academy of the Philippines in partnership with JICA, strengthening his expertise in development economics and strategic governance.

Government Career

Department of Trade and Industry

Appointed by President Rodrigo Duterte, Macatoman served as Undersecretary of the Department of Trade and Industry (DTI), overseeing the Trade Promotions Group (TPG) and the Office of Special Concerns. In this capacity, he led transformational initiatives across multiple sectors:

His work in investment promotion focused on attracting global investors and enhancing the competitiveness of Philippine industries on the world stage. Recognizing that small businesses form the backbone of the Philippine economy, Macatoman emerged as a fierce advocate for MSME development, spearheading programs to empower micro and small entrepreneurs across the nation.

He chaired the Export Development Council, positioning Philippine exports for greater international competitiveness. Additionally, Macatoman served as Senior Official for the BIMP-EAGA, facilitating regional economic cooperation and trade facilitation among member nations.

Commission on Filipinos Overseas

Macatoman's tenure at the Commission on Filipinos Overseas (CFO) as Acting Secretary and Officer-in-Charge reflected his deep commitment to the welfare of the global Filipino diaspora. During this period, he championed initiatives to strengthen the protection of overseas Filipino workers (OFWs) and expanded engagement programs connecting millions of Filipinos abroad with opportunities and support services in the home country.

Corporate and Civic Leadership

Beyond government service, Macatoman built an influential presence in both the private sector and civil society.

As Founder, President, and CEO of the **Global Empire International Group of Companies**, he directed a diverse portfolio of business ventures focused on trade, investment facilitation, and economic development.

He served as Chairman of the Foreign Chamber Council of the Philippines (FCCP), fostering collaboration between foreign investors and local Philippine industries. His leadership helped position the Philippines as an attractive investment destination while supporting local business growth.

Recognizing the untapped economic potential of the Bangsamoro region, Macatoman assumed the role of Chairman of the **Bangsamoro Business Council**, advocating for inclusive investment, inclusive growth, and sustainable economic development in the Mindanao region.

His commitment to public service extended to the Armed Forces of the Philippines, where he holds the rank of Reserve Lieutenant Colonel.

Global Halal Economy and Media Presence

Macatoman has positioned himself as a thought leader in the emerging global halal economy. He authored the book **Global Halal Economy**, which explores the vast economic opportunities within the halal industry and its potential for catalyzing international trade, fostering interfaith dialogue, and creating prosperity across Muslim-majority regions.

His expertise reaches the public through media platforms. He hosts **Kabuhayan at Negosyo** (Livelihood and Business), a weekly program broadcast on Channel 23 and DWIZ 882 (AM radio), where he discusses business opportunities, entrepreneurship, and livelihood development for Filipino workers and entrepreneurs.

Awards and Recognition

Macatoman's contributions to economic development, public service, and corporate leadership have earned him numerous distinctions:

- **Management Man of the Year** (2017), Philippine Council of Management
- **Asian Humanitarian Businessman of the Year**, 5th Global Officials of Dignity (G.O.D.) Awards at the United Nations
- **Most Outstanding Alumnus**, University of the East
- **Ten Outstanding Young Filipinos** (2012)
- **Paul Harris Fellow**, Rotary International

Legacy and Impact

Macatoman's career represents a bridge between government, private enterprise, and civic engagement. His advocacy for MSMEs has contributed to policy frameworks that support small business growth and resilience. His leadership in the halal economy has elevated the Philippines' position within the global Islamic economy, opening new markets and partnerships. Through his work on behalf of overseas Filipino workers and the Bangsamoro business community, he has demonstrated commitment to inclusive development and regional prosperity.

Further Reading

- Macatoman, Abdulgani M. *Global Halal Economy*.

See Also

- Bangsamoro region
- Commission on Filipinos Overseas
- Department of Trade and Industry
- Micro, small, and medium enterprises in the Philippines
- Overseas Filipinos
- BIMP-EAGA

Editorial Notice: BangsamoroPedia is a curated knowledge archive. Its pages are maintained by the editorial administrator to help ensure historical accuracy. If you would like to suggest corrections, share sources, or contribute information, please message the administrator through the official Facebook page: **Notable Muslim Filipinos**.

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